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Core applications in my company run on the Linux server.

Thanks to my background in open source, I have been waiting for such an event—and when I got to know about the CXO Summit, I was interested in attending it. The CIO Summit 2010 turned out to be a great experience, and was, of course, helpful.

Tryst with Linux and open source: Core applications in my company run on the Linux server with MySQL and Tomcat. We use Ubuntu for some of our desktops as well.

Why I feel open source rocks for businesses: I think the expensive licensing costs of non-open source products would definitely make open source a sure-shot hit in organisations. I myself have assumed the role of an open source campaigner in my group.

My vote goes to: While I prefer Red Hat's software solutions, as they are user friendly, Ubuntu's rich graphics make it ideal for the desktop.

A word of caution: It can prove fruitful if those companies that adopt Linux and open source hire and then make efforts to retain employees possessing open source expertise.



The CXO Summit inspired me to motivate others to use Linux and open source.

I am a regular *LFY* reader. I came to know about the Open Source India 2010 CXO Summit through the *LFY* magazine itself. It was a nice experience to attend the event. I felt extremely sad that I missed attending the first two days. Apart from the summit, the seminar about developing the Android phone OS was quite interesting.

Tryst with Linux and open source: Yes, I was using Linux and open source prior to attending the CXO summit.

Basically, I am a qualified network and systems administrator, sound designer and engineer. I began reading *LFY* soon after the completion of my RHEL course in 2007. With the help of tutorials published in the magazine, I learnt to use Red Hat Enterprise Linux, Fedora and many other Linux software.

Instead of using proprietary software, after reading about a particular recording software for Linux which was featured in *LFY*, I tested it. I came across a few problems initially, but I found the performance of open source video software far better compared to tools such as Premier Pro, Avid, FCP, etc.

Using Linux and open source tools, I have also designed one audio-video and networking-related education project for government schools, which is currently pending approval by the education ministry.

The CXO Summit inspired me to make use of open source in my organisation, and in turn, motivate others to use Linux and open source.

Why I feel open source rocks for businesses: I strongly recommend open source to organisations because it meets most of my expectations from an enterprise-grade software solution, which are as follows:

- It is secure: I feel for any software tool or platform, security is an important element to consider. Performance and speed come next. Compared to other OSs and tools, open source software offers all these critical elements. Based on the principle of 'Less luggage, more comfort', Linux and open source tools need fewer gigabytes, are less bloated, and offer a higher performance.
- Source code is modifiable: It is possible to edit or re-configure the source code as per the requirements of the organisation.
- Solutions are economical or available for FREE: While proprietary operating systems and tools are expensive and have legal limitations, Linux and open source tools are economical or available for free. Besides, these tools have no legal limitations or binding clauses.

A word of caution: There are also a few pitfalls in adopting Linux and open source, mostly from the users' standpoint. Invariably, problems arise when there is a lack of understanding on the part of the user, or when there is a lack of expert help available to train the organisation's employees about the deployed Linux and open source solutions.

Also, sometimes, device drivers for some of the open source tools may not be readily available.



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